

Common Application | Undergraduate

Finley Scott | CAID: APP_018 | Fall 2026

Applicant information

App ID	APP_018
First Name	Finley
Last Name	Scott
Date Of Birth	4/21/07
Mailing Address	1017 Demo Drive, Richmond, VA 23220
Primary Phone Number	804-555-0117
Email Address	Not provided
Gender	Male
Ethnicity	Asian
Country	USA
Region	Southeast

Education and application details

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Name of HS	Richmond High School
Counselor Name	Morgan Allen
Intended Major	Political Science, Sociology, Economics, Business
Admission Year	2026
Admission Term	F
Unweighted GPA	3.98
Weighted GPA	4.65
Rank	Not provided
Superscored SAT Score	1550
Superscored ACT Score	Not provided

AP Courses

AP Computer Science Principles, AP Microeconomics, AP Spanish Language, AP Macroeconomics, AP Psychology, AP Art History, AP Chemistry, AP French Language

Total APs

8

IB Courses

Not provided

Total IBs

Not provided

Activities

Student council representative, School newspaper editor, Peer math tutor, Debate team member, Youth orchestra musician, Yearbook photographer, Coding club member

Awards

School music achievement award

Hooks

Not provided

Personal essay

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Prompt: Describe an experience that changed how you think or learn.

A space for the quiet reply

During a student council conversation, the most confident voices answered first. I was ready to support a proposal until someone asked who had not been heard. That pause made me realize that participation is something a group must make room for.

My first response was to make the problem smaller than it really was. I wanted a neat explanation and a quick result. When that did not work, I felt embarrassed by how much I had assumed. Looking back, the useful part of the experience began when I admitted that I needed more information. I wrote down what I knew, what I was guessing, and what I still needed to ask. That simple separation helped me move forward without pretending to be certain.

The next attempt was slower. I listened to another perspective, changed one part of my approach, and checked whether the change made sense. I learned that revision is more than replacing a wrong answer with a right one. Sometimes it means changing the question itself. I also learned to explain my choices clearly enough that someone else could challenge them. An idea became more useful when it could survive a conversation rather than only look convincing in my notebook.

That lesson has followed me into ordinary parts of my school life. When I do not understand a reading, I try to identify the sentence where I lost the argument. When a group disagrees, I ask what each person is trying to accomplish. These habits do not solve every problem, and I still sometimes rush toward an answer. But they give me a way to begin again. I am becoming more comfortable saying that I have not figured something out yet, provided that I can describe the next step I will take.

My interest in the social sciences and business comes partly from this experience. I want to study how ideas meet the complicated conditions of actual lives. I hope college will give me stronger methods, unfamiliar perspectives, and people who will question my assumptions. I do not expect every class to confirm the direction I have chosen. I want some of them to make me reconsider it. Learning should enlarge the questions I can ask as well as the answers I can offer.

The lesson I carry with me is to make room for people before claiming to represent them. It sounds modest, but it changes how I work. I now see patience, curiosity, and a willingness to revise as practical responsibilities. I want to contribute to a college community by taking other people seriously, making my reasoning clear, and continuing when a first attempt fails. The moment that matters most to me is no longer the moment I can announce an answer. It is the moment I understand enough to take a more thoughtful next step.

Essay is fictional and generated for this prototype. It is embedded in this CommonApp document.